

A portrait of Governor Gavin Newsom, a man with dark hair and a slight smile, wearing a dark suit, white shirt, and dark tie. He is positioned in the center of the frame. In the background, an American flag is visible on the left, and a wooden wall with a clock is on the right.

**GOV. NEWSOM
SIGNS AN
ORDER TO
PLAN AN AI KILL
SWITCH FOR
CALIFORNIA.**



THE ORDER NEWSOM SIGNED FRIDAY

On September 18, Gov. **Gavin Newsom** signed an executive order asking a state panel to recommend AI safety rules within two months — including a **kill switch**, an emergency shutoff for frontier AI models.

THE PANEL'S DEADLINE

2 months

for the expert panel to deliver its recommendations

WHAT THE PANEL MUST CONSIDER

The panel is asked to weigh embedding **independent auditors inside AI labs**, requiring outside verification of company safety reports, and advancing the kill switch itself, verified by an independent verification organization.



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**We're not waiting to act
— we're going to speed
up our work on
substantial and
responsible AI
oversight **before it's too
late.****

— GAVIN NEWSOM, GOVERNOR OF CALIFORNIA

A KILL SWITCH IS NOT A BUTTON

It would not be a literal switch someone could press. Each major AI lab would instead create and run its own **set of protocols to shut down a model**, verified on an ongoing basis by an outside organization.



**California has only a
limited capacity to
control what a
company incorporated
in Delaware does with a
data center in Oregon
to serve a customer in
Colorado.**

— MAX HARMS, MACHINE INTELLIGENCE RESEARCH
INSTITUTE

CALIFORNIA STILL SHAPES WHAT WASHINGTON DOES

The SF Standard reports California "sets trends that often end up determining how things get done at the federal level."



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REGULATION AND
WHAT CALIFORNIA
IS DOING ABOUT IT.**

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